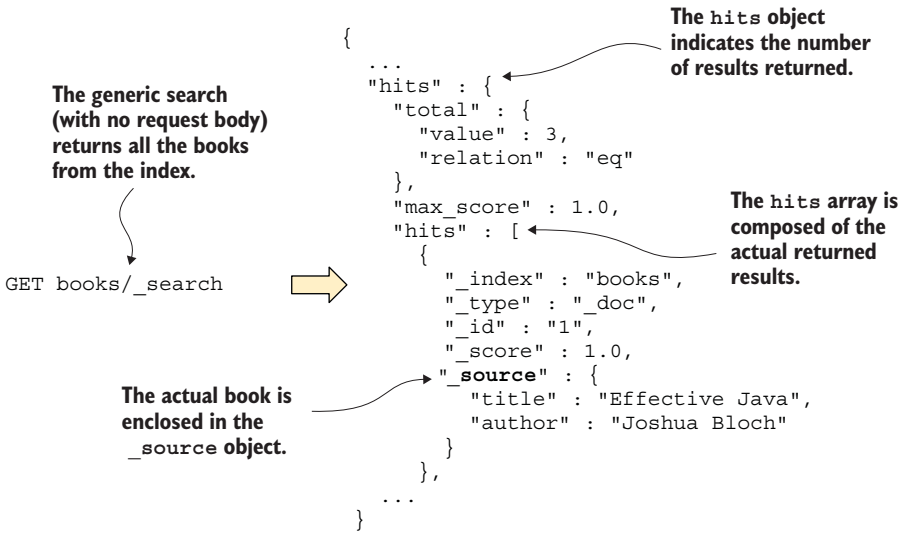


Figure 2.12 Retrieving all documents using the search API

Generic search is a short form of the match_all query

The query `GET books/_search` that you saw previously is a short form of a special query named `match_all`. Usually, a request body is added to the URL with a `query` clause, such as the one in listing 2.5. When we omit the query body while invoking the `_search` endpoint, it is an instruction to Elasticsearch that the query is a `match_all` query—which means *match everything*. The full query is shown here, but we rarely need to write the body if we are planning to fetch all records without any `query` clauses:

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "match_all": { }
  }
}
```

However, if we need to boost the scores of all the results for whatever reason, we can create the `match_all` query and declare an additional `Boost` parameter:

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "match_all": {
       "Boost":2
    }
  }
}
```

All results will have a score of 2

The takeaway point is that whenever we invoke a `_search` endpoint without a body, it's a `match_all` query.